



The AI Automation Checklist

Find the work worth automating first, score it in 20 minutes, and avoid the mistakes that sink most first projects.

Auto Solution

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STEP 1

List the repetitive work

Ask each person on the team to write down anything they do at least weekly that follows roughly the same steps. Don't filter yet. Use this list to jog memories.

Area	Common repetitive tasks
Finance & accounts	☐ GST / bank / ledger reconciliation ☐ Monthly MIS and management reports ☐ Invoice data entry from PDFs ☐ Payment reminders to customers ☐ Expense and vendor bill matching
Sales & customer service	☐ Answering the same questions on WhatsApp or email ☐ Qualifying and routing new enquiries ☐ Booking calls, demos or site visits ☐ Updating the CRM after every conversation ☐ Sending quotes and follow-ups
Operations	☐ Checking order or shipment status across portals ☐ Copying data between ERP, sheets and other tools ☐ Daily and weekly operations reports ☐ Inventory and stock reconciliation ☐ Chasing approvals
HR & admin	☐ Payslip generation and dispatch ☐ Attendance reconciliation ☐ Onboarding document checks ☐ Leave and policy questions from staff ☐ Monthly compliance reports

STEP 2

Score each task

Give every task a score from 1 (low) to 5 (high) on these five questions, then add them up. Anything scoring 18 or more is a strong first candidate.

Question	What a 5 looks like
Hours per month, across everyone	20+ hours a month of someone’s time
How rule-based is it?	Clear rules, almost no judgement calls
How stable is the process?	Hasn’t changed in a year
Cost of mistakes today	Errors cost money, penalties or customers
Is the input digital and reachable?	Data already in a system, sheet or email

Scoring sheet

Task	Hours	Rules	Stable	Risk	Data	Total

STEP 3

Check you're ready

Before you start building, make sure the basics are in place. Each unticked box is a risk worth discussing.

The process

- ☐ Someone can explain every step, including exceptions
- ☐ There are real examples of inputs and outputs to test on
- ☐ You know where the result needs to end up

The data

- ☐ Inputs are digital (or can be scanned reliably)
- ☐ You can give access to the systems involved
- ☐ Sensitive data can stay in your environment

The people

- ☐ One person owns the automation on your side
- ☐ The team that does the work today is involved
- ☐ You've agreed what 'done' and 'good' look like

The measurement

- ☐ You've measured how long it takes today
- ☐ You know the current error rate, even roughly
- ☐ You'll review results after 30 days

STEP 4

Avoid the common mistakes

Automating the loudest complaint, not the biggest win

Use the score, not the mood in the room.

Starting with a platform instead of a pilot

Automate one workflow end to end on real data first. Its result becomes your business case.

Ignoring exceptions

Most of the work hides in the 10% of cases that don't follow the rules. Design a review step for them.

Producing output nobody uses

End in something a person already opens: the report, the sheet, the WhatsApp message.

No alerts when things break

Every automation needs checks on its input and a message to a human when something looks wrong.

Giving an AI agent too much access

Give agents the narrowest permissions they need and log every action they take.

Want a second pair of eyes?

Bring your scored list to a free 30-minute call. We'll tell you honestly what's worth automating and what isn't.

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